

## APPENDIX

### “Accumulated Errors of Fourteen Centuries”

The Gospel manuscript GA 1700 is the most recent dated manuscript representing Family 35 that has come to my attention. It is dated at 1623 AD and is held by the National Library of Greece. I wish to register my sincere thanks to the Center for the Study of New Testament Manuscripts for making available a digital copy of this manuscript. Although from the seventeenth century, the hand is very legible. I have done a complete collation of this manuscript for John’s Gospel, and invite attention to the result. However, I wish to analyze that result using the following quote as a backdrop, taken from the preface to the Revised Standard Version, p. ix.

The King James Version of the New Testament was based upon a Greek text that was marred by mistakes, containing the accumulated errors of fourteen centuries of manuscript copying... We now possess many more ancient manuscripts of the New Testament, and are far better equipped to seek to recover the original wording of the Greek text.

The first thing that interests me here is the allegation that the TR contains “the accumulated errors of fourteen centuries of manuscript copying”. If that is true, then a seventeenth century MS should be a veritable wastebasket of ‘accumulated errors’. So let us see how GA 1700 fares.

To begin, it has no fewer than 136 deviations from the family archetype (in John), making it by far the worst of the 54 family representatives that I have collated for that book; the second worst has ‘only’ 41 deviations. Although due to carelessness and mixture 1700 is a marginal member of Family 35 in John, it is nonetheless clearly a member. Of the 12 readings that I rank as +++, it misses one; of the 17 readings I rank as ++--, it misses one; of the 17 readings I rank as ++, it misses one; of the 15 readings I rank as +--, it misses none; of the 12 readings I rank as +, it misses three; for a total of six out of 44. Although by no means a thing of pristine beauty, it belongs to the family.<sup>1</sup>

I will now list the 136 deviations, showing selected further attestation that the 1700 variant has; any **f**<sup>35</sup> MSS that I have collated are listed first, followed after the [] by anything else. My lists of evidence are selective, being sufficient for my purpose. The first reading is that of the family

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<sup>1</sup> For the Family 35 profile and the key, please see Part II above.